

IT Support Knowledge Base

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1. VPN Access

1.1 Requesting VPN Access

All employees requiring remote access to internal systems must request VPN access through the IT Service Portal (Request Type: 'VPN Access Request'). Approval from the employee's reporting manager is required before provisioning. Standard turnaround time is 1 business day.

1.2 VPN Client

The company uses GlobalProtect VPN client version 6.2. Installation packages for Windows, macOS, and Linux are available on the Software Center. After installation, connect using portal address vpn.acmecorp.com and authenticate with your company SSO credentials plus a one-time MFA code.

1.3 Common VPN Issues

If the VPN client shows 'Connection Timed Out', check that you are connected to a stable internet network and that your local firewall is not blocking UDP port 4500. If the issue persists after a restart, raise a ticket with category 'VPN - Connectivity'. VPN sessions automatically disconnect after 10 hours of continuous use and must be reconnected manually.

2. Password Reset

Employees can reset their own password via the Self-Service Password Reset (SSPR) portal at password.acmecorp.com, provided they have previously registered security questions and a recovery phone number. Password resets requested outside SSPR (e.g., via the helpdesk) require identity verification using employee ID and a manager confirmation email.

Password policy: minimum 12 characters, must include at least one uppercase letter, one number, and one special character. Passwords expire every 90 days and cannot repeat the last 5 passwords. Accounts are locked after 5 failed login attempts and unlock automatically after 30 minutes, or immediately via helpdesk override.

3. Software Installation

Standard business software (Microsoft 365, Slack, Zoom, Adobe Reader) is pre-approved and can be installed directly from the Software Center without approval. Non-standard or paid software requires submission of a 'Software Request Form' with business justification, to be approved by the employee's department head and reviewed by IT Security for license compliance.

Administrator rights are not granted by default. Employees needing temporary elevated access for installation should request 'Just-in-Time Admin Access', which grants local admin rights for a maximum of 4 hours and is fully logged for audit purposes.

4. Laptop Requests

New joiners receive a standard-issue laptop (Dell Latitude 5440 or MacBook Air M3, depending on role) provisioned automatically 3 business days before their start date. Replacement laptop requests due to damage must include an incident report; loss or theft must additionally be reported to Security within 24 hours. Upgrade requests for higher-spec machines require manager approval and are evaluated based on role requirements (e.g., engineering, design).

Standard laptop refresh cycle is every 3 years. Loaner laptops are available from the IT desk for employees whose primary device is under repair, for a maximum loan period of 10 business days.

5. Email Setup

Company email runs on Microsoft 365 Exchange Online. New accounts are provisioned with the format `firstname.lastname@acmecorp.com` and a default mailbox quota of 50GB. Email can be configured on mobile devices via the Outlook mobile app after enrolling the device in the company's Mobile Device Management (MDM) system, Intune.

Shared mailboxes and distribution lists can be requested via the IT Service Portal under 'Email - Shared Resource Request', requiring approval from the relevant team lead. External email forwarding is disabled by default for security reasons and cannot be enabled except by CISO exception approval.

6. IT Support Contact & SLAs

Priority	Definition	Response SLA	Resolution SLA
P1 - Critical	Full system outage / security breach	15 minutes	4 hours
P2 - High	Major function impaired for many users	1 hour	1 business day
P3 - Medium	Single user impacted, workaround exists	4 hours	3 business days
P4 - Low	General request, no urgent impact	1 business day	5 business days

IT Helpdesk operates Monday-Friday, 8:00 AM - 8:00 PM IST. Outside these hours, only P1 tickets are monitored via the on-call pager (contact: it-oncall@acmecorp.com).